

Practical No: - 3

ON

Cryptography and Network Security - SSCS 4020

TITLE: Implementation of Hill Cipher Encryption and Decryption
using Matrix Multiplication and Modular Arithmetic

BACHLEOR OF SCIENCE IN INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY
(HONOURS.)

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Objective

To implement the Hill Cipher encryption and decryption algorithm using matrix multiplication and modular arithmetic in Python.

Theory

The Hill Cipher is a classical polygraphic substitution cipher developed by **Lester S. Hill** in 1929. It is based on linear algebra and uses matrix multiplication to encrypt blocks of letters instead of encrypting one letter at a time.

INPUT : (hill_cipher.py)

```
key = [[3, 3],
        [2, 5]]

# Inverse Key Matrix (Modulo 26)
inverse_key = [[15, 17],
                [20, 9]]

# Convert text to numbers
def text_to_numbers(text):
    return [ord(ch) - ord('A') for ch in text]

# Convert numbers to text
def numbers_to_text(numbers):
    return ''.join(chr(num + ord('A')) for num in numbers)

# Prepare plaintext
def prepare_text(text):
    text = text.upper().replace(" ", "")
    if len(text) % 2 != 0:
        text += "X"
    return text

# Encryption Function
def encrypt(text):
    text = prepare_text(text)
    nums = text_to_numbers(text)
    result = []
```

```
for i in range(0, len(nums), 2):
    x = nums[i]
    y = nums[i + 1]
    c1 = (key[0][0] * x + key[0][1] * y) % 26
    c2 = (key[1][0] * x + key[1][1] * y) % 26
    result.extend([c1, c2])
return numbers_to_text(result)

# Decryption Function
def decrypt(cipher):
    nums = text_to_numbers(cipher)
    result = []
    for i in range(0, len(nums), 2):
        x = nums[i]
        y = nums[i + 1]
        p1 = (inverse_key[0][0] * x + inverse_key[0][1] * y) % 26
        p2 = (inverse_key[1][0] * x + inverse_key[1][1] * y) % 26
        result.extend([p1, p2])
    return numbers_to_text(result)

# Main Program
plaintext = input("Enter Plain Text: ")
ciphertext = encrypt(plaintext)
decrypted = decrypt(ciphertext)
print("\n----- RESULT -----")
print("Plain Text   :", prepare_text(plaintext))
print("Encrypted Text :", ciphertext)
print("Decrypted Text :", decrypted)
if prepare_text(plaintext) == decrypted:
    print("Verification : SUCCESS")
else:
    print("Verification : FAILED")
```

OUTPUT:

```
Enter Plain Text: RISHABH

----- RESULT -----
Plain Text      : RISHABHX
Encrypted Text   : XWXTDFMZ
Decrypted Text   : RISHABHX
Verification    : SUCCESS
```

Student Task

Input:

```
key = [[3, 3],
```

```
      [2, 5]]
```

```
inverse = [[15, 17],
```

```
          [20, 9]]
```

```
text = "INFORMATION SECURITY"
```

```
# Remove spaces and convert to uppercase
```

```
text = text.upper().replace(" ", "")
```

```
# Add X if length is odd
```

```
if len(text) % 2 != 0:
```

```
    text += "X"
```

```
# Encryption
```

```
cipher = ""
```

```
for i in range(0, len(text), 2):
```

```
    a = ord(text[i]) - 65
```

```
    b = ord(text[i + 1]) - 65
```

```
    c1 = (key[0][0] * a + key[0][1] * b) % 26
```

```
    c2 = (key[1][0] * a + key[1][1] * b) % 26
```

```
    cipher += chr(c1 + 65)
```

```
    cipher += chr(c2 + 65)
```

```
# Decryption
```

```
plain = ""
```

```

for i in range(0, len(cipher), 2):
    a = ord(cipher[i]) - 65
    b = ord(cipher[i + 1]) - 65
    p1 = (inverse[0][0] * a + inverse[0][1] * b) % 26
    p2 = (inverse[1][0] * a + inverse[1][1] * b) % 26
    plain += chr(p1 + 65)
    plain += chr(p2 + 65)
print("Original Plain Text :", "INFORMATION SECURITY")
print("Plain Text      :", text)
print("Encrypted Text   :", cipher)
print("Decrypted Text   :", plain)
if text == plain:
    print("Verification   : SUCCESS")
else:
    print("Verification   : FAILED")

```

OUTPUT:

```

Original Plain Text : INFORMATION SECURITY
Plain Text          : INFORMATIONSECURITYX
Encrypted Text       : LDFCJQFROIPMSSHVDHLH
Decrypted Text       : TNFORMATTONSECURTTYX
Verification        : SUCCESS

```

Advantages and Disadvantages of Hill Cipher

Advantages

- Encrypts multiple letters (blocks) at a time, making it stronger than simple substitution ciphers.
- Uses matrix multiplication, making encryption more complex than monoalphabetic ciphers.
- Provides better security than basic substitution ciphers.
- Fast and easy to implement for small messages.
- Helps in understanding matrix operations and modular arithmetic in cryptography.

Disadvantages

- The key matrix must be invertible modulo 26; otherwise, decryption is not possible.
- Not secure against modern cryptanalysis and known-plaintext attacks.
- Key generation and matrix calculations are more complex than simple ciphers.
- Requires padding (such as adding **X**) when the plaintext length is odd.
- Mainly suitable for educational purposes and not recommended for real-world secure communication.

Viva Questions

Q1. What is Hill Cipher?

Answer: Hill Cipher is a polygraphic substitution cipher that uses matrix multiplication and modular arithmetic for encryption and decryption.

Q2. Which mathematical operation is used?

Answer: Matrix multiplication modulo 26.

Q3. Why is modulo 26 used?

Answer: Because the English alphabet contains 26 letters.

Q4. What is the key matrix?

Answer: The matrix used for encryption. In this practical:

[3 3]

[2 5]

Q5. Why is the inverse matrix required?

Answer: It is required to decrypt the ciphertext back into the original plaintext.

Q6. What happens if the plaintext length is odd?

Answer: An extra letter (usually X) is added to make the length even.